HEIRSTONE CONSULTING

EVENT VENUES AND LEGACY

Planning for day two

What became of 30 Olympic, Expo and World Cup sites after the crowds left, and what the Gulf and Egypt can settle now for the venues they are building next



SIX NUMBERS FROM THE REPORT

156%

average real cost overrun of the Olympic Games from 1960 to 2016; every Games with data overran its budget

61%

of the seats in its seven new World Cup stadiums Qatar planned to remove; in 2025 FIBA still listed Al Janoub at 44,325 seats, against a planned 20,000

14%

of the London Aquatics Centre's Games seats kept for everyday use: 2,500 of 17,500

5,632

homes planned at Harumi Flag, Tokyo's former athletes' village, on about 18 hectares

80%+

of Expo 2020's buildings and infrastructure kept at Expo City Dubai, established in 2022, the year the Expo closed

11

new stadiums in Saudi Arabia's 2034 World Cup plan, most listed at about 46,000 seats; Al Hilal plays at the 26,000-seat Kingdom Arena

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

Heirstone Consulting advises master developers, sovereign and private investors, land agencies and tourism authorities across the Middle East and Africa on destinations, event sites and specialised real estate. This report uses public sources current in 2026: audit offices and government statistics, event organisers and legacy bodies, the Bureau International des Expositions, peer-reviewed studies, operator and developer disclosures, and the press where it quotes a primary party.

Where we have combined published figures to make a new one, such as homes per hectare, cost per seat or visits per hectare, the calculation and its inputs are shown and labelled Heirstone analysis. The report takes no view on the merits of any host or event; its subject is how event sites are planned for the years after.

SUMMARY OF FINDINGS

The day after an event is decided years before it opens

We followed 30 Olympic, Expo and World Cup sites from closing ceremony to 2026. The sites that reopened quickly had their landowner and their buyer or tenant fixed in contracts before the event. Where these were settled afterwards, the main reuse took between three and 21 years, and some sites are still waiting.

1 **Contracts made before the event set the pace of reuse.**

Hannover's Expo ran on a trade-fair estate that stayed in use, Expo City Dubai was established in the year the Expo closed and part of London's Olympic Park reopened within a year. In each case the landowner and its buyers or partners were fixed in advance. Where the anchor or development partner came later, the main reuse took three to 21 years: Sydney Olympic Park had 65 residents 11 years after the Games.

2 **Seats are the hardest asset to carry into day two.**

London kept 14% of its Aquatics Centre seats by removing two temporary stands. Qatar planned to remove 61% of the seats in its seven new stadiums; by 2025 we found no confirmed removal, and follow-on tournaments were using the bowls. Where no tenant pays its way, the public owner carries the gap.

3 **Homes are the most dependable legacy.**

Athletes' villages convert because a flat still has a buyer once the event has gone. Paris is converting its village into 2,807 homes, with residents from 2025, and Tokyo's Harumi Flag holds 5,632. London sold its village for £825m before the Games, about £293,000 a home.

4 **District legacies take decades, and the cost line comes first.**

Sevilla TechPark reports 35,806 jobs on the Expo 92 site, 33 years on. Milan's innovation district had realised about 35% of its investment programme nine years after its Expo. Meanwhile overruns are systematic: every Olympic Games with data has overrun, by 156% on average in real terms.

5 **The Gulf's pipeline is large and still early enough to test.**

Saudi Arabia's 2034 plan lists 15 stadiums, 11 of them new and most at about 46,000 seats, while Al Hilal plays at the 26,000-seat Kingdom Arena. Riyadh's Expo 2030 legacy plan houses 150,000 people at 25,000 per km^2, two and a half times the density planned at Expo City Dubai. Egypt already holds about 255,000 seats in its three largest stadiums and staged the 2019 Africa Cup of Nations at about five months' notice; its day-two task is to turn that record into a year-round calendar.

WHAT IT MEANS

Governments and land agencies should write the day-two owner, tenant and seat count into the host agreement, with a published reopening date.

Master developers should treat the village and the event estate as the first phase of a district and phase the rest on absorption measured in decades.

Investors and lenders should underwrite households and anchor leases, and treat seat revenue as event-day income.

30

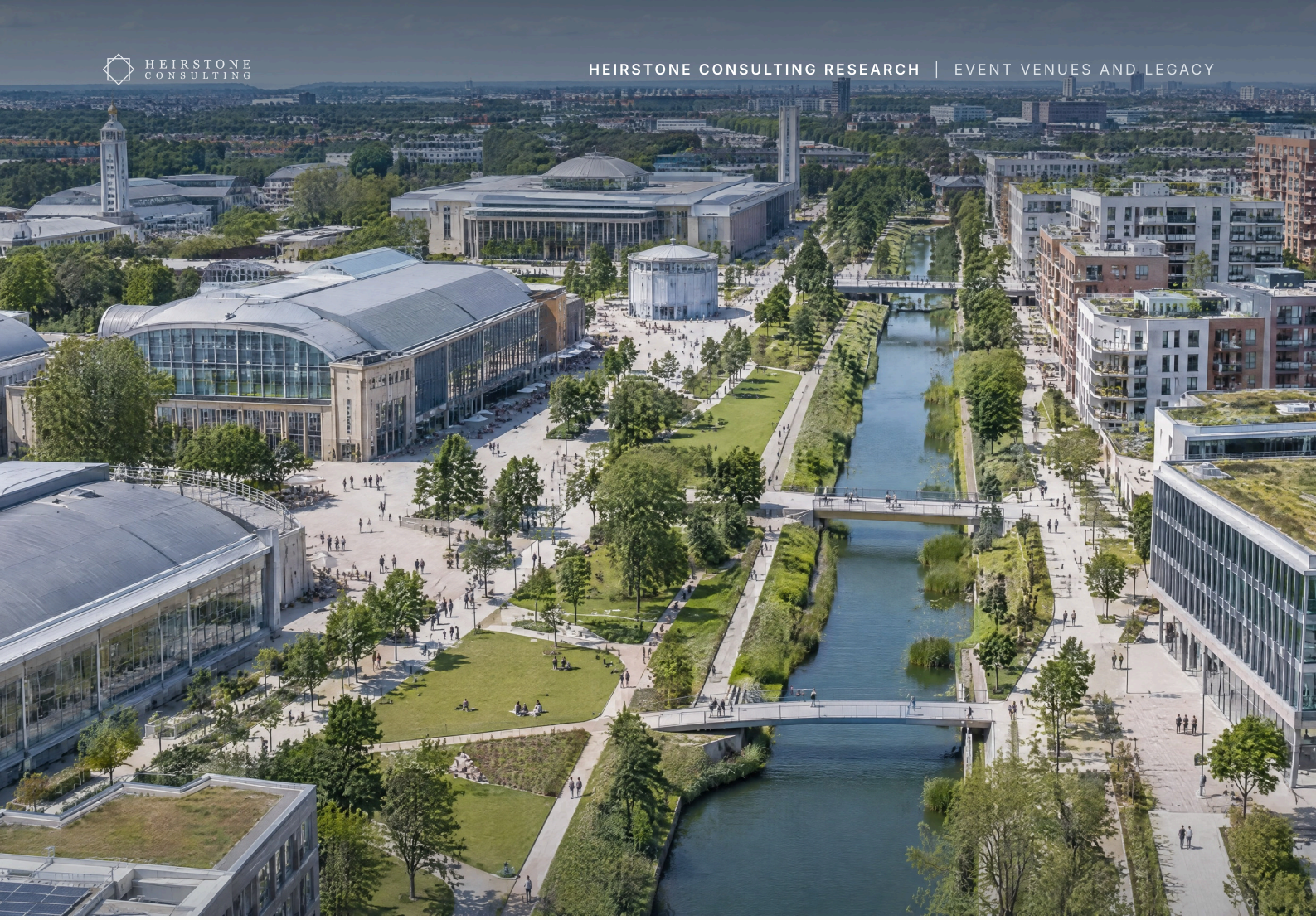
sites in 17 countries in the Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark: 12 Olympic, 9 Expo and 9 World Cup

8

tests in the Heirstone day-two readiness scorecard, each tied to a benchmark case

<1 year

median time to the main post-event use where the owner and the use were fixed before the event



CHAPTER 1

01

The Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark

Twelve Olympic, nine Expo and nine World Cup sites, from Barcelona 1992 to Osaka 2025, followed from the closing ceremony to 2026.

Most writing on event legacy starts from the event: what it cost, how many came, what was promised. We started at the other end. For 30 sites we recorded what stands on the land today, who owns and runs it, how many people live or work there, and how long it took to get from the closing ceremony to the first permanent use.

The sample covers 17 countries. It includes the cases usually cited as successes, such as Barcelona, Lisbon and London, and those usually cited as failures, such as Hellinikon in Athens and the Amazon arena in Manaus. It also includes the Gulf's two most recent mega-events, Expo 2020 Dubai and the 2022 World Cup in Qatar.

Two results stand out. The type of event largely sets the form of the legacy: Expos tend to become districts and World Cups leave stadiums. Within each type, the sites that reopened fastest were the ones whose owner and users were under contract before the event began.

THE BENCHMARK

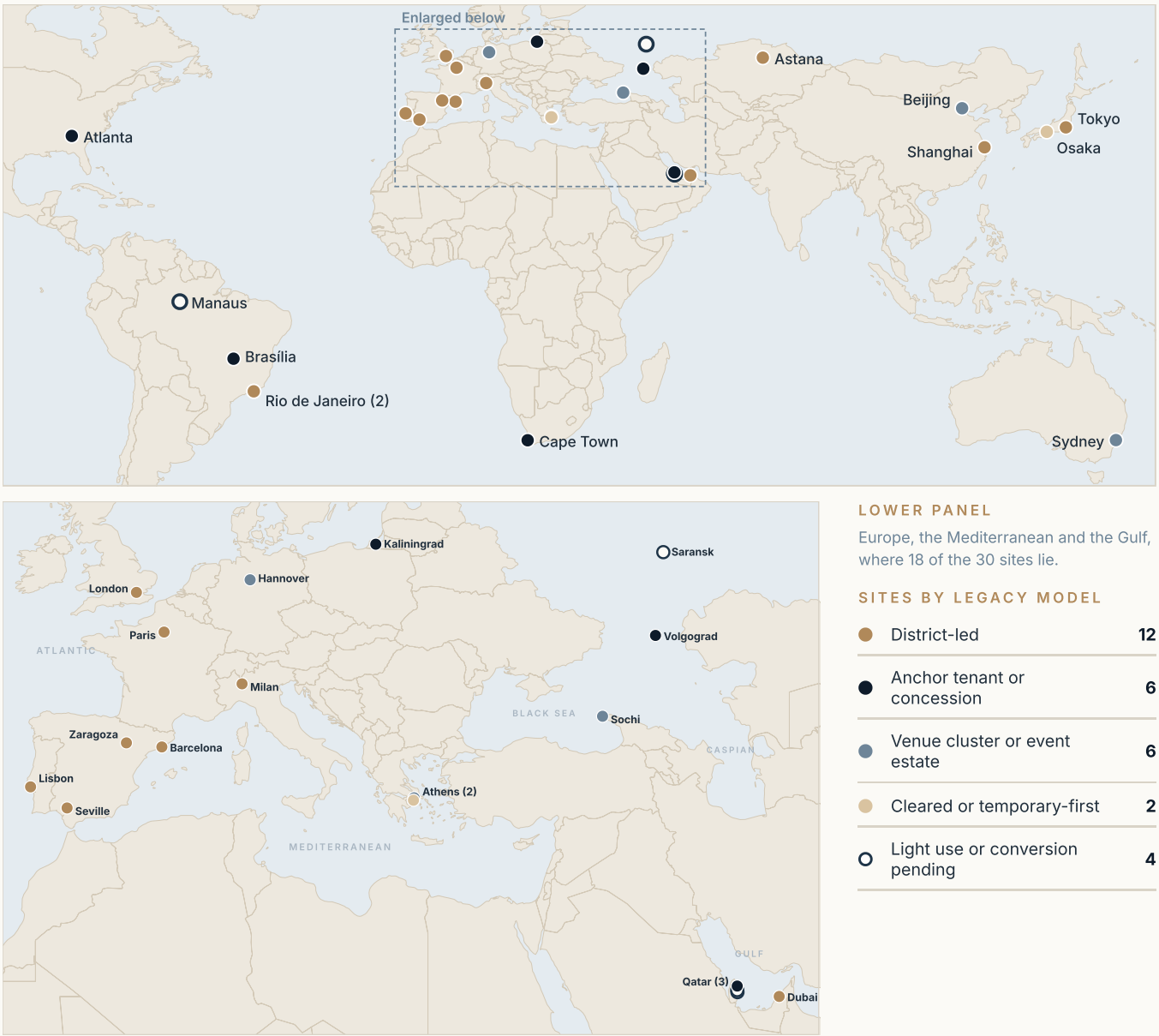
Where the 30 sites are, and what they became

EXHIBIT 1

Twelve of the 30 sites became districts; ten are still mainly stadiums

Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark sites by legacy model, status at 2026

District-led · Anchor tenant or concession · Venue cluster or event estate · Cleared or temporary-first · Light use or conversion pending



LOWER PANEL

Europe, the Mediterranean and the Gulf, where 18 of the 30 sites lie.

SITES BY LEGACY MODEL

District-led	12
Anchor tenant or concession	6
Venue cluster or event estate	6
Cleared or temporary-first	2
Light use or conversion pending	4

Source: Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark 2026, compiled from the BIE, SOLIDEO, LLDC, Sydney Olympic Park Authority, Arexpo, Sevilla TechPark, Lamda Development, Expo City Dubai, operators and the press (table on page 6). Legacy model is a **Heirstone classification**. Positions are GeoNames points for the city, district or park concerned, so most are approximate; Dubai is plotted at Jebel Ali, Osaka at the city and Stadium 974 at Doha.

Twelve sites became districts with homes, offices or campuses on the event land. Six are stadiums kept busy by an anchor tenant or a concession, and six are venue clusters or event estates that still mainly host sport, fairs and visitors. Two were cleared or are being cleared for new uses. Four are in light use or still waiting for a planned conversion.

THE BENCHMARK

Thirty sites, one table

Years to main use: calendar years from the event to the opening of the principal post-event use; 0 for stadiums with a club tenant from the start; for Sydney, venues and then homes. Area is the event site or legacy district as published. Legacy models as in Exhibit 1. n/v: not verified in a primary or reputable source. n/a: not applicable. Planned figures are targets, not outcomes.

SITE AND EVENT	AREA (HA)	LEGACY MODEL	YEARS TO MAIN USE	HOMES OR RESIDENTS	JOBS OR ANCHOR	STATUS, 2026
OLYMPIC GAMES (12)						
Vila Olímpica Barcelona 1992	n/v	District	n/v	n/v	n/v	Residential district
Olympic Stadium Atlanta 1996	n/v	Anchor tenant	n/v	none	Georgia State (2017)	University stadium
Olympic Park Sydney 2000	n/v	Venue cluster	0; homes 11+	4,848 residents	26,000 jobs (plan)	15,000 homes planned
OAKA complex Athens 2004	n/v	Venue cluster	n/v	none	n/v	n/v
Hellinikon Athens 2004	620	Cleared or temporary	n/v	n/v	n/v	Redevelopment by Lamda
Olympic Green Beijing 2008	n/v	Venue cluster	0	none	n/v	Stadium reused in 2022
Olympic Park London 2012	227	District	1 to 2	2,818 (East Village)	UCL East (2023)	Park open since 2014
Olympic Park Sochi 2014	n/v	Venue cluster	n/v	n/v	n/v	Stadium: club tenant
Barra Olympic Park Rio 2016	n/v	Venue cluster	n/v	none	Schools; institute	Arenas to schools (2024)
Athletes' village Rio 2016	n/v	District	n/v	n/v	n/v	n/v
Harumi Flag Tokyo 2020	18	District	n/v	5,632 units	n/v	Village site in 2021
Athletes' village Paris 2024	52	District	1	2,807 homes	6,000 jobs (target)	Converting from 2025
WORLD EXPOS (9)						
Isla de la Cartuja Seville 1992	215	District	n/v	n/v	35,806 jobs	Technology park
Parque das Nações Lisbon 1998	50	District	n/v	n/v	n/v	City district
Messe, Kronsberg Hannover 2000	160	Venue cluster	0	Kronsberg district	n/v	Trade fair in use
Ranillas meander Zaragoza 2008	25	District	n/v	n/v	Offices (n/v)	Aquarium operating
Expo Park Shanghai 2010	523	District	n/v	n/v	n/v	n/v
MIND Milan 2015	110	District	3 to 7	n/v	Hospital; campus	35% of plan invested
Expo site Astana 2017	25	District	n/v	n/v	Financial centre	300,000+ visits a year
Expo City Dubai Dubai 2020	438	District	under 1	35,000 planned	40,000 planned	COP28 host (2023)
Yumeshima Osaka 2025	155	Cleared or temporary	pending	n/a	n/v	Pavilions dismantled
FIFA WORLD CUP STADIUMS (9)						
Cape Town Stadium 2010	n/v	Anchor tenant	11	none	none	City grant R41m (2022)
Arena da Amazônia 2014	n/v	Light use or pending	none yet	none	none	No club tenant listed
Mané Garrincha 2014	n/v	Anchor tenant	n/v	none	n/v	Operator; naming deal
Kaliningrad Stadium 2018	n/v	Anchor tenant	0	n/v	n/v	Club home
Volgograd Arena 2018	n/v	Anchor tenant	0	none	n/v	Club home
Mordovia Arena 2018	n/v	Light use or pending	n/v	none	n/v	No long-term tenant
Stadium 974 2022	n/v	Light use or pending	3+	waterfront plan	n/v	Standing; used 2025
Lusail Stadium 2022	n/v	Light use or pending	3+	none	Community (plan)	Arab Cup final, 2025
Al Bayt Stadium 2022	n/v	Anchor tenant	0	none	Hotel, shops (plan)	League and cup use

Source: Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark 2026, compiled from BIE Expo pages; SOLIDEO; LLDC; Sydney Olympic Park Authority Master Plan 2050; ABS census 2011 and 2021; Lamda Development; Tokyo Metropolitan Government; Sevilla TechPark; Arexpo and TEHA Group (2025); Expo City Dubai; Georgia State University (2017); IOC (2024); City of Cape Town, DHL Stadium Integrated Annual Report 2021-22; StadiumDB; Qatar sources as in Exhibit 6. Legacy model and years to main use are **Heirstone analysis**; inputs are listed in the notes.

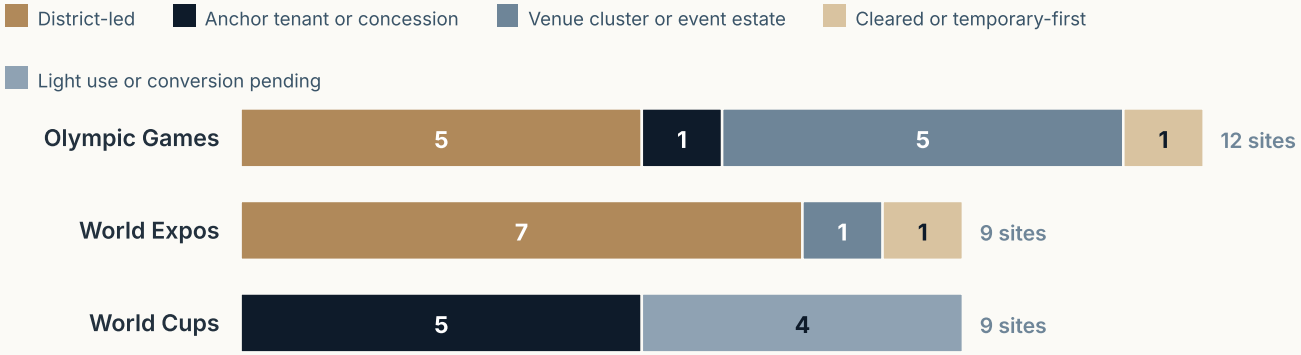
WHAT THE EVENT LEAVES

Expos turn into districts and World Cups leave stadiums. Olympic sites split between the two.

EXHIBIT 2

Seven of nine Expo sites became districts; none of the nine World Cup sites did

Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark sites by event type and legacy model, number of sites



Source: Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark 2026. **Heirstone classification** of each site's principal use at 2026; see the table on page 6.

The form of the legacy follows the form of the event. An Expo occupies one contiguous site for six months and leaves a land bank: Lisbon, Seville, Milan, Astana and Dubai all turned theirs into districts, and only Hannover, which ran on an existing trade-fair estate, and Osaka, which is clearing its island for a resort, did not. A World Cup leaves a stadium in each host city. In our sample, five of the nine kept a club tenant or a concession and four are in light use or waiting for a conversion that has not yet happened.

Olympic sites split down the middle. The athletes' village is a housing project and behaves like one; the venue park behaves like a stadium cluster. Barcelona, London, Tokyo and Paris made districts out of their villages, while Sydney, Athens, Beijing, Sochi and Rio kept venue parks built around events.

This matters for planning because the day-two question differs by event. For an Expo host it is mainly about land absorption and for a World Cup host about tenants and seat counts; an Olympic host faces both, on different plots.

One anchor recurs at Olympic and Expo sites: education. Universities and schools took space at no fewer than six of the 30 sites, in several cases as the first permanent tenant.

EDUCATION AS THE FIRST TENANT

Atlanta 1996	Stadium sold to Georgia State University and converted for its football team (2017)
London 2012	UCL East and London College of Fashion (2023); Chobham Academy, for 1,800 pupils aged 3 to 19 (2013)
Rio 2016	Carioca Arena 2 to a federal institute (1,400 places); Arena 3 to a sports school; Future Arena to four schools (2024)
Paris 2024	Two school groups with 35 classes; 130-unit student residence used before, during and after
Milan 2015	University of Milan science campus; Human Technopole in the former Palazzo Italia
Astana 2017	An IT university and the Astana Hub IT park alongside the financial centre

CHAPTER 2

02

The budget always moves

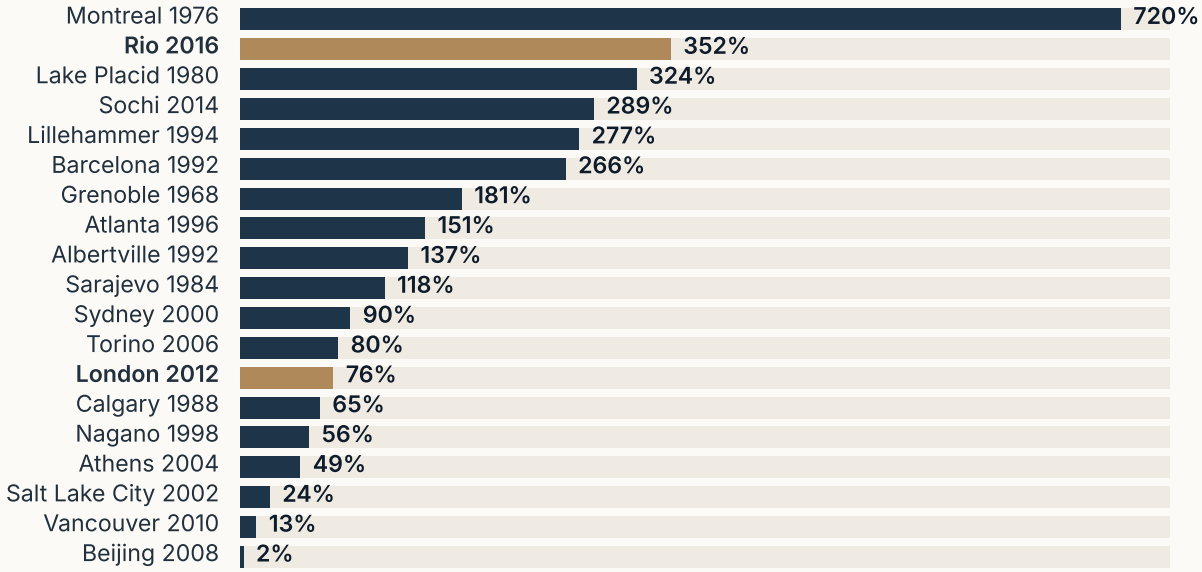
The Oxford Olympics Study is the longest consistent record of what the Games cost. Its 2016 edition found an overrun in every Games with data since 1960, averaging 156% in real terms with a median of 90%; the 2020 update put the average at 172%. Oxford's authors note that no other type of megaproject they have studied overruns every time.

For legacy planning the lesson is practical. A day-two vehicle that inherits debt from the event, or whose business plan assumes the bid budget, starts its life with a hole in it. The question to ask of any host plan is whether the day-two district still works at the outturn cost.

EXHIBIT 3

Every Games with data overran; Montreal by 720%, Beijing by 2%

Real cost overrun of the Olympic Games from bid to outturn, sports-related costs, %, 1968 to 2016 (19 Games with data)



Source: Flyvbjerg, Stewart and Budzier, The Oxford Olympics Study 2016 (Saïd Business School, 2016); Flyvbjerg, Budzier and Lunn, Regression to the Tail (Environment and Planning A, 2020) for Rio 2016, revised from 51%. Sports-related costs exclude wider infrastructure such as roads, rail and airports.

The median is more useful than the mean. Oxford found that it fell from 166% for Games held before 1999 to 51% for those after. Overruns have shrunk, yet a legacy vehicle should still be planned on an outturn well above the bid.

90%

median real overrun, all Games with data, 1960 to 2016

51%

median overrun for Games held after 1999, down from 166%

15 of 19

Games overran by more than 50% in real terms

COST AND WHAT IT BUYS

Cost figures keep moving after the event, and the Games that built least spent least

The first published cost of an event is rarely the last. Oxford put Rio 2016 at US$4.6bn and a 51% overrun in 2016; four years later, with fuller data, the same team put it at US$13.7bn and 352%, three times the first estimate. Any post-event cost quoted within three or four years of the closing ceremony should be treated as provisional.

Scope also needs care. Oxford counts only sports-related costs and leaves out roads, rail and airports, which are often reported in the same headline total. In Qatar, Webuild, one of the stadium contractors, puts the investment in the seven new stadiums and the one refurbished stadium at around US$6.5bn, a figure for the venues alone. Comparisons that mix venue and city-wide spending say little about the venues.

Expos carry the same risk on the revenue side, because the crowd is uncertain until the gates open. The BIE records 18.1 million visits for Hannover 2000 on 160 hectares, 21.5 million for Milan 2015 on 110 and more than 29 million for Osaka 2025 on 155. Osaka has since taken most of its pavilions down and reused many of the parts elsewhere.

The Games that built least spent least. In Oxford's data the sports-related cost of Los Angeles 1984 was US$0.7bn in 2015 prices, about US$0.1m for each athlete, against US$1.4m for London 2012 and US$7.9m for Sochi 2014. A host that reuses venues starts day two with less to pay for and less to fill.

3x

Oxford's revision of Rio 2016's sports-related cost between its 2016 and 2020 studies

US$0.7bn

sports-related cost of Los Angeles 1984 in 2015 prices, the lowest of any Summer Games since 1972 in Oxford's data

US$6.5bn

invested in Qatar's seven new and one refurbished World Cup stadiums, according to Webuild

EXHIBIT 4

Sochi spent US$7.9m per athlete on its Games; Los Angeles 1984 spent US$0.1m

Sports-related outturn cost per athlete, US$m in 2015 prices, selected Summer and Winter Games, 1976 to 2016 (total cost and athletes shown)



Source: Flyvbjerg, Stewart and Budzier, The Oxford Olympics Study 2016 (Saïd Business School, 2016), for sports-related outturn cost in 2015 US$ and athlete numbers; Flyvbjerg, Budzier and Lunn, Regression to the Tail (2020) for Rio 2016. Cost per athlete is **Heirstone analysis** (cost divided by athletes). Sports-related costs exclude wider infrastructure such as roads, rail and airports.



CHAPTER 3

03

Seats are the hardest asset

A stadium seat earns on event days, while a flat or an office earns every day of the year. That difference explains most of what happened to the venues in our benchmark.

The event sets the size. An Olympic opening ceremony or a World Cup semi-final needs a bowl that few cities fill more than a handful of times a year, and the seats are built for that peak. Afterwards the same seats have to be filled by a domestic club, a university team or a concert promoter whose crowd is a fraction of the tournament's.

The benchmark shows four ways out of a tournament-sized bowl. Where a venue takes none of them, it becomes a fixed cost for its public owner, as Exhibit 8 shows.

1 Remove seats

London Aquatics Centre: 17,500 seats in Games mode, 2,500 when it reopened in 2014.

2 Sign a tenant

Cape Town: rugby anchor and naming rights in 2021; the city grant then came in 31.5% under budget.

3 Fill the calendar

Qatar: Arab Cup 2025, U-17 World Cup to 2029, FIBA World Cup 2027, Asian Games 2030.

4 Change the use

Rio: arenas became an institute, a sports school and four schools. Atlanta: a university ground.

> *Rio's Future Arena was designed to be taken down and rebuilt as four schools. They opened in 2024, eight years after the Games.*

The next three sections take the routes in turn: what seat removal achieved where it was carried out, what a booked calendar has done for Qatar's stadiums since 2022, and who pays when a venue takes none of the four.

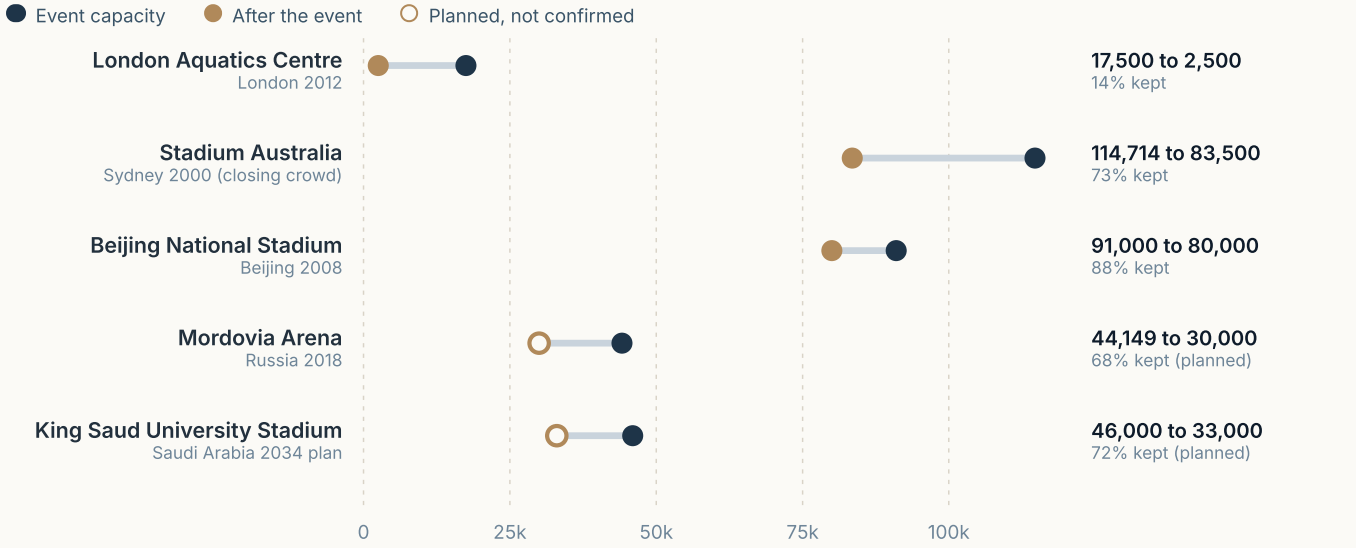
THE SEAT HAIRCUT

Downsizing happened where it was designed and paid for before the event

EXHIBIT 5

London kept 14% of its aquatics seats; the Olympic stadiums kept most of theirs

Seats at the event and after it, selected Olympic and World Cup venues and one 2034 plan



Source: Queen Elizabeth Olympic Park, London Aquatics Centre; LLDC, Annual Report and Accounts 2013-14; IOC, Biggest stadium in the world, and Guinness World Records, Highest capacity Olympic stadium (Stadium Australia; the event figure is the 2000 closing-ceremony crowd); StadiumDB (Beijing; Mordovia); Realnoe Vremya (2018), Mordovia legacy mode; ArchDaily (2024), King Saud University Stadium. **Heirstone analysis** of share kept.

London's Aquatics Centre is the clearest case. It seated 17,500 in Games mode and has 2,500 permanent seats. The extra seats sat in temporary stands on either side of the pools, which were removed, and the centre reopened to the public in 2014. London's 12,000-seat basketball arena, the largest single temporary structure in Olympic history, was being dismantled within months of the Games, and some of its seats were re-used at the Lee Valley Hockey and Tennis Centre.

Paris cut before it built: SOLIDEO delivered a 5,000-seat aquatics centre on a final budget of €176.0m, and it opened to the public in 2025, the year after the Games. Saudi Arabia has written the same logic into one 2034 venue: King Saud University Stadium seats 25,000 today, is planned at 46,000 for the World Cup and is to revert to 33,000 afterwards.

Stadium conversions have mostly been modest: Beijing kept 88% of its Olympic seats and Sydney 73%. Sydney's A$80m post-Games reconfiguration, completed in 2003, cut Stadium Australia to 83,500 seats, about 12% of its A$690m build cost. Atlanta took the other route: its Olympic stadium was sold to Georgia State University in 2017 and converted for college football.

Where removal was left as an intention, it slipped. Rio's Future Arena, designed to be taken down and rebuilt as schools, opened as four schools only in 2024. Saransk planned to take its arena from 44,149 seats to 30,000 after the 2018 World Cup; by 2020 the stadium had no long-term tenant.

QATAR AFTER 2022

Qatar planned to remove 61% of its new seats, and has so far filled them with a calendar of tournaments

EXHIBIT 6

Three years on, Al Janoub was still listed at 44,325 seats, against a planned 20,000

Qatar 2022 World Cup stadiums: organiser design capacity and published legacy plan, against observed use to 2025

STADIUM	DESIGN SEATS	PLANNED LEGACY	PLANNED CUT	PLANNED DAY-TWO USE	OBSERVED, 2023 TO 2025
Lusail	80,000	20,000	75%	Community space: schools, cafés, sport, clinics, shops	Arab Cup final venue, 2025
Al Bayt	60,000	32,000	47%	Hotel, shops, sports health centre, community use	Asian Cup 2023 matches; Arab Cup 2025 opener; league matches
Ahmad bin Ali	40,000	21,000	48%	Al-Rayyan club ground	Arab Cup 2025 venue; no reduction confirmed
Education City	40,000	20,000	50%	Half the seats donated	Arab Cup 2025 venue; no reduction confirmed
Al Thumama	40,000	20,000	50%	Arena, sports clinic, boutique hotel	No reduction confirmed
Al Janoub	40,000	20,000	50%	Legacy mode at 20,000 seats	Listed at 44,325 seats in 2025; 8,200-seat FIBA arena in 2027
Stadium 974	40,000	0	100%	Dismantle and reuse; waterfront development	Still standing in 2025; Arab Cup 2025 venue
Seven new stadiums	**340,000**	**133,000**	**61%**	Calendar: Arab Cup 2025 in six of the 2022 stadiums, U-17 World Cup every year 2025-29, FIBA World Cup 2027, Asian Games 2030	

Source: Al Jazeera, Qatar 2022 World Cup stadiums at a glance (2020, updated 2022), for design capacities and legacy plans; Goal (2018), Lusail; Arabian Business (2014), Al Bayt; ArchDaily (2015, 2019), Ahmad bin Ali and Al Janoub; The Stadium Business (2020), Education City; Qatar 2022 Supreme Committee, Al Thumama and Stadium 974; Webuild (2025); The Peninsula (2025); FIFA (2024); FIBA (2025). Planned cut and totals are **Heirstone analysis** on the organiser's design figures, which are lower than the capacities later listed for matches. Khalifa International, the eighth venue, was an existing stadium.

Qatar published the most ambitious downsizing plan of any recent host. Across its seven new stadiums, 207,000 of 340,000 design seats were to come out, many of them to be donated abroad, with hotels, shops, clinics and community space in the freed upper tiers. Stadium 974, built from 974 shipping containers, was to be dismantled entirely and its site redeveloped on the waterfront.

None of the sources we reviewed confirms a completed seat removal by 2025. Lusail hosted the Arab Cup final in 2025, and FIBA's venue guide for 2027 still lists Al Janoub at 44,325 seats, against a planned 20,000. Stadium 974 had not been moved by 2025 and was one of the six Arab Cup venues.

The calendar explains much of this. Al Bayt hosted Asian Cup matches after 2022, and six of the World Cup stadiums staged the 2025 Arab Cup. Qatar holds the FIFA U-17 World Cup every year from 2025 to 2029, the FIBA Basketball World Cup in 2027 and the Asian Games in 2030. In practice it has replaced seat removal with a booking programme, and has started to change use where the calendar asks for it: for the FIBA World Cup, Al Janoub's roof will close to make an 8,200-seat basketball arena.

Two planning lessons follow. A demountable design creates an option, and the option is exercised only once a buyer and a funded removal contract are in place. A booked calendar postpones the day-two question until the bookings run out. For Qatar's larger bowls that point comes after 2030, when the domestic league and local events will have to carry them.

207,000
seats Qatar planned to remove from its seven new stadiums, on the organiser's design figures

44,325
seats still listed for Al Janoub in 2025, against a planned legacy of 20,000

5
editions of the FIFA U-17 World Cup booked in Qatar, one a year from 2025 to 2029

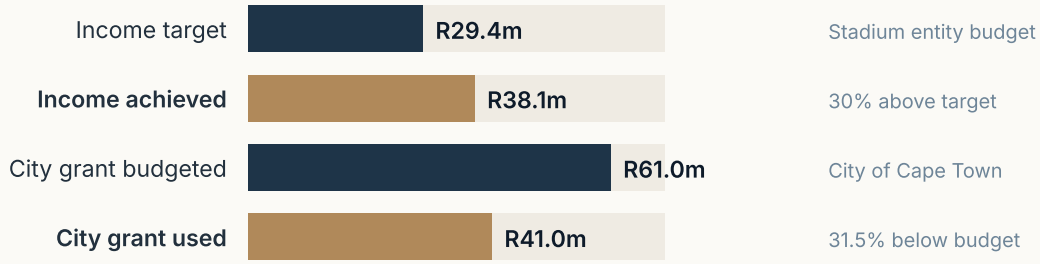
WHO PAYS FOR EMPTY SEATS

When no tenant fills a tournament bowl, the public owner pays for the rest

EXHIBIT 7

With a rugby anchor and a naming partner, Cape Town Stadium beat its income target by 30% and used 31.5% less city grant

Cape Town Stadium, financial year 2021-22: income and City of Cape Town grant against budget, ZAR m



Source: City of Cape Town, DHL Stadium Integrated Annual Report 2021-22 (2022): income R38.1m against a target of R29.4m; grant reduction of 31.5% against a R61m budget. Values rounded to R0.1m.

Cape Town shows what an anchor does to the numbers. In 2021-22, with DHL as naming partner from 2021 and the Stormers and Western Province Rugby playing most of their home matches at the stadium, income beat its target by 30% and the city grant came in at R41m, 31.5% below the R61m budgeted. The formal anchor tenancy was still being finalised that year, under a binding heads of agreement with the city.

London shows the cost of converting late. The NAO put the stadium's build cost at £429m, and its conversion for football, budgeted at £190m, cost £323m. West Ham's £2.5m annual rent is about a third of 1% of that £752m, against a forecast loss of more than £10m a year. Russia's 2018 venues show the same pattern: StadiumDB reports federal support for about 90% of Kaliningrad's budget in 2020.

EXHIBIT 8

Where no tenant covers the running cost, the public owner pays it every year

Build cost, public cost after the event and anchor, selected Olympic and World Cup stadiums

VENUE	BUILD COST	PUBLIC COST AFTER THE EVENT	ANCHOR AND OPERATOR
London Stadium	£429m build; £323m conversion	Forecast loss of more than £10m a year (2018)	West Ham on a 99-year lease at £2.5m a year
Cape Town Stadium	n/v	City grant of R41m in 2021-22, against R61m budgeted	Rugby anchor and DHL naming partner from 2021
Kaliningrad Stadium	RUB 18.5bn	Federal support for about 90% of the budget (2020)	FC Baltika; regional management from 2019
Volgograd Arena	RUB 17.1bn	Federal subsidies planned for maintenance in the first years	FC Rotor Volgograd
Mordovia Arena, Saransk	RUB 17bn	n/v	No long-term tenant by 2020

Source: NAO, London 2012 post-Games review (2012); London Assembly, The full cost of London Stadium (2018); FourFourTwo (2016), West Ham lease; City of Cape Town, DHL Stadium Integrated Annual Report 2021-22; StadiumDB, stadium pages for Kaliningrad, Volgograd and Mordovia (build cost in roubles as reported; support figures from its news summaries). n/v: not verified in a primary or reputable source.

An anchor or a concession changes the arithmetic. Brasília's Mané Garrincha is run by an operator that sold its naming rights to the bank BRB for R$7.5m in 2022, according to StadiumDB. In Saransk the arena was planned to drop from 44,149 seats to 30,000 after the World Cup in a city of about 315,000, and by 2020 it had no long-term tenant.



CHAPTER 4

04

Homes and districts carry the legacy

An athletes' village is a housing estate that opens with a fortnight of sport. After the event its flats still have buyers and tenants, which is why villages are the most dependable legacy in our benchmark.

London's East Village has 2,818 homes on 27 hectares, all sold to two buyers before the Games. Paris began handing its village sectors back for conversion in 2024, and Tokyo's Harumi Flag, built on the 2021 village site, has 5,632 homes planned.

Villages differ in density, timing and who carries the sale risk. Harumi Flag fits about 313 homes on each of its 18 hectares, three times the density of East Village and nearly six times that of the Paris village. Density is a choice about the district that follows, and it is made when the athletes' blocks are designed.

EXHIBIT 9

Tokyo's village is three times as dense as London's and six times as dense as Paris's

Homes after conversion per hectare of village site, gross



Source: Tokyo Metropolitan Government, Harumi 5-chome West District (Harumi Flag: about 18 ha, 5,632 units); Qatari Diar, Olympic Village investor announced (2011) for East Village; SOLIDEO village and media cluster pages. **Heirstone analysis.**

THE VILLAGES

Selling the homes before the Games took the risk off the public balance sheet

EXHIBIT 10

Five villages, three ways of carrying the risk

Olympic and media villages: homes after the event, site, risk holder and occupation

VILLAGE	HOMES AFTER THE EVENT	SITE (HA)	WHO CARRIED THE RISK	OCCUPATION
East Village London 2012	2,818, of which 1,379 affordable	27	Pre-sold: affordable homes to Triathlon Homes for £268m (2009); market homes to Qatari Diar and Delancey for £557m (2011)	Planned in 2011 for residents from 2013
Athletes' village Paris 2024	2,807	52	Four developer groups built each sector to convert; sectors returned in 2024	Homes from 2025; 6,000 residents and 6,000 jobs targeted
Media Village Paris 2024	1,400	70	Supervised by SOLIDEO; 1,582 journalists housed at Games time	950 homes delivered in 2024, before the Games
Harumi Flag Tokyo 2020	5,632	18	Tokyo Metropolitan Government redevelopment project, approved in 2016	Used as the athletes' village in 2021
Olympic Village Vancouver 2010	c.1,100, of which 252 affordable	n/v	City took on the CAD 630m development debt as lender of last resort	Debt repaid with CAD 70m recovered, 2014

Source: NAO, London 2012 post-Games review (2012); Qatari Diar (2011) and Get Living, East Village brand launch (2011); SOLIDEO sector pages (Universeine, Quinconces, Belvédères, Écoquartier fluvial, media cluster); Tokyo Metropolitan Government, Harumi 5-chome West District; City of Vancouver, Olympic Village.

London sold both halves of its village before the Games: 1,379 affordable homes to Triathlon Homes for £268m in 2009 and 1,439 market homes to Qatari Diar and Delancey for £557m in 2011. The £825m total is about £293,000 a home, and it moved completion and sales risk off the public balance sheet before the athletes arrived. Vancouver kept the risk. The city became lender of last resort, took on the CAD 630m development debt and announced in 2014 that it had repaid all of it and recovered CAD 70m more.

Tokyo built its village through a Metropolitan Government redevelopment project approved in 2016, so the site was planned as a 5,632-home district on about 18 hectares before it housed athletes in 2021. Its density was set by the district plan, not by the event.

Paris made reversibility a contract term. The Universeine sector, which held 5,850 athlete beds, was handed back in 2024 and becomes 125,000 m^2 of mixed use with 2,500 Interior Ministry staff. A 130-unit student residence housed students before the Games, athletes during them and students again from the end of 2024. SOLIDEO reports 95% of its promised physical legacy delivered by the end of 2025, with the rest due by 2028.

£293k

recovered per home when London pre-sold its village for £825m

950

Paris Media Village homes delivered in 2024, before the Games

1,379

affordable homes in East Village, sold to Triathlon Homes for £268m in 2009

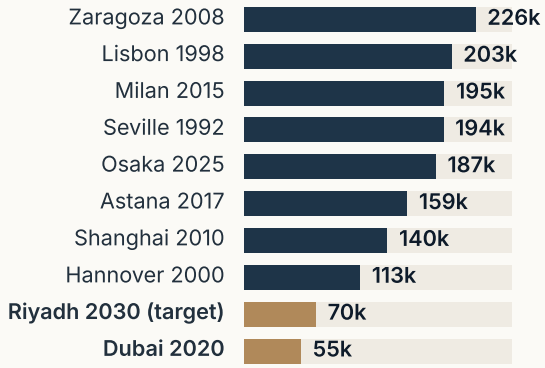
EXPO LAND

Expo sites fill over decades. Dubai laid out its site for the district that would follow.

EXHIBIT 11

Dubai used its site at a quarter of the usual Expo intensity

Visits per hectare of Expo site, thousands



Source: BIE Expo pages (site area and visitors; Osaka uses the BIE's "more than 29 million"); Expo 2030 Riyadh Company (6m m² site, 42m visits targeted). Lisbon uses the BIE's 50 ha. **Heirstone analysis.**

An Expo site is sized for six months of crowds. Dividing BIE visitor numbers by site area shows how hard each site was used. Lisbon, Seville, Milan and Zaragoza handled between about 194,000 and 226,000 visits per hectare. Dubai handled 55,030 across 438 hectares, about a quarter of that.

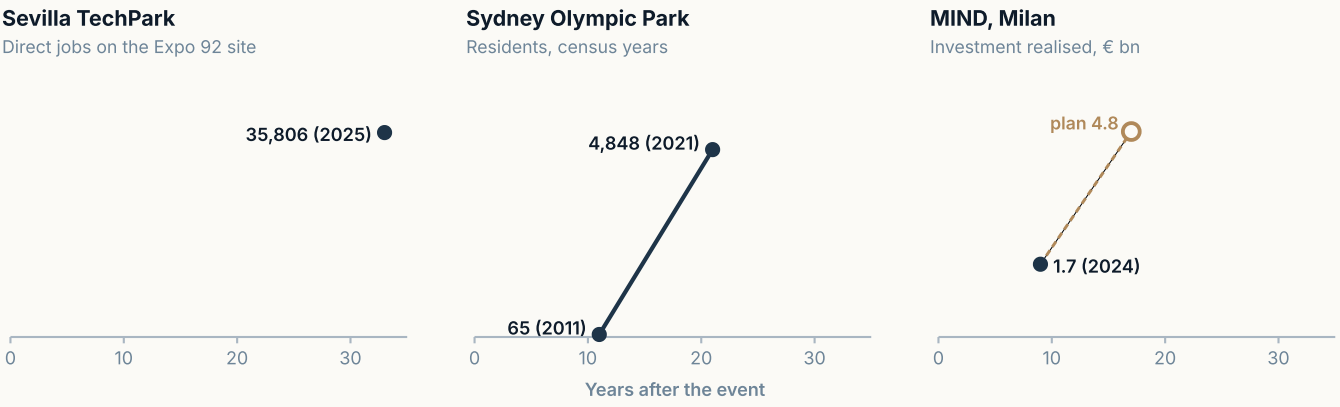
On this measure Expo 2020 was laid out for the district that would follow it, which fits with Expo City Dubai keeping more than 80% of the Expo's buildings and infrastructure and reopening six months after closing. Riyadh's 2030 site, 6 km² for 42 million targeted visits, would run at about 70,000 visits per hectare, close to Dubai's.

Expo City Dubai is early on its curve. It recorded 783,600 visitors in 2025, about 2,150 a day against some 132,400 a day during the Expo, and hosted 37 events. Tenant occupancy of its 135,000 m² of Grade A offices rose 34% during the year. It does not yet publish resident numbers against its target of 35,000.

EXHIBIT 12

Sydney Olympic Park went from 65 residents to 4,848 between years 11 and 21

Measured outcomes on three former event sites by years after the event; MIND shown against its 2032 programme



Source: Sevilla TechPark (35,806 direct jobs, 2025); ABS, Census QuickStats 2011 and 2021 (Sydney Olympic Park); TEHA Group and Arexpo, MIND executive summary (2025).

Filling the district takes far longer than the event. Sevilla TechPark reports 602 companies and 35,806 direct jobs on the Expo 92 site, about 167 jobs per hectare, 33 years after the fair. Lisbon turned its Expo site into a city district with homes, a shopping centre and visitor attractions, according to the BIE.

Sydney Olympic Park had 65 residents 11 years after the Games and 4,848 after 21; its 2050 master plan now provides for 15,000 homes over 25 years. MIND had realised about 35% of its €4.8bn programme nine years after Milan's Expo. A district on an event site should be underwritten on an absorption curve of 15 to 30 years.

SUMMITS

Summit hosts now reuse event estates, with beds as the binding limit

EXHIBIT 13

COP28 and COP29 reused event estates; Delhi and Belém built new venues

Venue, origin and scale of recent climate summits and the 2023 G20 leaders' summit

SUMMIT	VENUE	ORIGIN OF THE VENUE	NEW BUILD	SCALE
COP26 Glasgow 2021	Scottish Event Campus	Existing event campus	none found	38,457 attended
COP27 Sharm El Sheikh 2022	Sharm El Sheikh	Resort city	n/v	33,449 registered; 49,704 attended, a record at the time
COP28 Dubai 2023	Expo City Dubai	Expo 2020 legacy site	Retained Expo buildings	Some 85,000 participants
G20 summit New Delhi 2023	Bharat Mandapam	Newly built exhibition centre	New centre	n/v
COP29 Baku 2024	Baku Olympic Stadium	Existing stadium	112,000 m² venue built beside it	Over 40,000 delegates expected
COP30 Belém 2025	New public park	Former aeroclub site	Federal spending of around R$5bn, incl. a R$946.9m contract	56,118 registered; about 45,000 attended

Source: UNFCCC, COP26 and COP27 pages and COP28 key takeaways; Carbon Brief, delegates analyses for COP27 (2022) and COP30 (2025), using UNFCCC data; Expo City Dubai, Sustainability Report 2025; Al Jazeera (2023), G20 venue; Euronews (2024), COP29 venue; Turismo em Foco (2020), Belém aeroclub site; Rádio Itatiaia (2025), federal spending as stated by the tourism minister. Participant figures use different bases: registered, attended, participants or expected.

Recent summits show a shift to existing estates. COP28 went to Expo City Dubai and, with some 85,000 participants, was the biggest COP of its kind according to the UNFCCC. COP29 in Baku used the Olympic Stadium, with a dedicated 112,000 m² venue built beside it. COP27 in Sharm El Sheikh drew 49,704 attendees on Carbon Brief's count of UNFCCC data, the largest COP up to that time. India held the 2023 G20 at Bharat Mandapam, a newly built exhibition centre in central New Delhi.

Belém took the other route. COP30 was held in a new public park on the site of the city's former aeroclub, and the tourism minister put federal spending at around R$5bn, including a R$946.9m contract and port works where two cruise liners were docked for the summit. Carbon Brief counted 56,118 registered delegates and about 45,000 attendees.

For a legacy estate, a summit is a reuse revenue line. It needs halls, a secure perimeter, transport and power, which an Expo site or an Olympic park already has. The binding constraint is beds, which depend on the city's hotel and housing stock more than on the venue.

> *COP28 met at Expo City Dubai, on a site whose halls and transport links were already in place.*

85,000
participants at COP28 in Dubai, the biggest COP of its kind, according to the UNFCCC

49,704
attendees at COP27 in Sharm El Sheikh, the largest COP up to that time

CHAPTER 5

05 A day-two readiness scorecard

The benchmark points to a short list of decisions that separate fast reuse from slow. We have turned them into eight tests. Each asks whether a decision has been made and contracted, because the record shows that intentions announced at bid stage are often not carried out.

Each test scores 2 where the commitment is contracted and public, 1 where it is stated but not yet contracted, and 0 where we cannot find it. Tests that do not apply, such as seat removal for a district with no temporary seats, are left out of the total. We read 75% or more of the applicable points as ready, 40% to 74% as having gaps to close, and below 40% as early or not yet disclosed.

The tests are cheapest to pass before design freeze. After the event, most of them can only be passed by spending money: London's stadium conversion cost £323m against a budget of £190m.

EXHIBIT 14

Eight tests, each tied to a case that met it and a case that missed it

The Heirstone day-two readiness scorecard

TEST	THE QUESTION TO ASK	MET IN THE BENCHMARK	MISSED IN THE BENCHMARK
1 **Owner on day two**	Is the post-event landowner, with its buyer or development partner, under contract before construction starts?	London pre-sold its village for £825m in 2009 and 2011.	Hellinikon is only now being redeveloped.
2 **Anchor signed**	Is a named principal tenant (club, university, institute or operator) contracted before opening?	Paris's Adidas Arena opened with its resident club five months before the Games.	Cape Town found its anchor in 2021, 11 years on.
3 **Day-two size**	Is permanent capacity set on the average local crowd, with the event peak added as temporary seats?	London Aquatics: 2,500 permanent seats of 17,500.	Saransk: 44,149 seats in a city of about 315,000.
4 **Removal funded**	Are temporary seats and structures budgeted, contracted and dated for removal at award?	London began taking down its 12,000-seat basketball arena within months.	Rio's Future Arena became schools only in 2024; Stadium 974 still stands.
5 **Built for the after-use**	Are buildings designed first for their permanent use, with the event as an overlay?	Paris returned village sectors for conversion in 2024; Expo City Dubai kept over 80% of the Expo.	London Stadium's conversion budget rose from £190m to £323m.
6 **Reopening date**	Is there a public date to reopen, within 12 months of closing?	Hannover kept its fairground in use; part of London's park reopened within a year.	Sydney Olympic Park had 65 residents 11 years after the Games.
7 **Follow-on calendar**	Are the first five years of events after the closing ceremony booked?	Expo City Dubai hosted COP28 in 2023; Qatar's stadiums are booked to 2030.	Arena da Amazônia has no tenant club listed.
8 **Absorption and reporting**	Is the district phased on observed absorption, with outcomes published every year?	Sevilla TechPark publishes firms, jobs and output; LLDC publishes planning monitoring.	LLDC's own data show 4 net home completions in 2023-24 against 2,453 permitted.

Source: Heirstone framework, built from the Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark 2026. Evidence from NAO (2012), SOLIDEO, LLDC, London Assembly (2018), Construction Enquirer (2013), Lamda Development, Sevilla TechPark, Expo City Dubai, ABS, IOC (2024), City of Cape Town (2022), StadiumDB and Realnoe Vremya (2018).

READING THE TOTAL

0% to 39%
early, or not yet disclosed

40% to 74%
gaps to close

75% and over
ready

2 of 8

tests, owner and anchor, that separate reuse within two years from waits of three to 21 years (Exhibit 15)

£323m

spent converting the London Stadium for football, against a £190m budget: the cost of meeting test 5 after the event

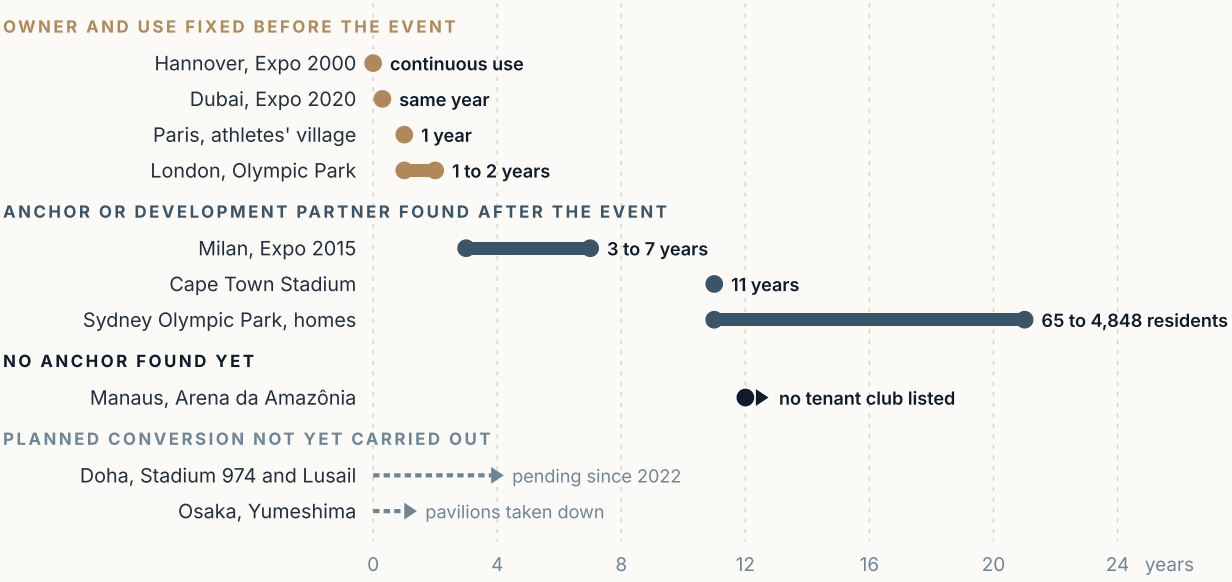
TESTING THE SCORECARD

Sites with their owner and use fixed before the event reopened within two years. The rest took three to 21.

EXHIBIT 15

The two tests that matter most separate fast reuse from slow

Years from the event to the principal post-event use, benchmark sites grouped by whether owner (test 1) and anchor or use (test 2) were fixed before the event



Source: Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark 2026; grouping is a **Heirstone judgement** on the public record at the time of each event. Hannover reused its existing fairground (BIE); Expo City Dubai was established in 2022, the year the Expo closed (Expo City Dubai); London's North Park opened in 2013 and the south of the park in 2014 (ITV; LLDC). Cape Town's rugby anchor and naming partner came in 2021 (City of Cape Town). Sydney's venues stayed in event use from 2000; the row shows residents at the 2011 and 2021 censuses (ABS). Manaus: StadiumDB lists no tenant club. Osaka: BIE.

We grouped the benchmark sites with a clear and verifiable post-event milestone by what was in place when the event opened. The four sites whose owner and use were fixed in advance reached their main post-event use in a median of under a year and none took more than two years. The three that found their anchor or development partner after the event took three to 21 years, two of them 11 years or more. Manaus has yet to find a club tenant.

The pattern rests on ten cases and our reading of each, and other things matter too. Saransk, a city of about 315,000, received a 44,149-seat stadium. Hellinikon, the former Athens airport, is now being redeveloped at scale by a private developer. Still, the two tests that best divide fast from slow are the two a host controls before construction starts.

The other six tests explain differences within the fast group. London passed the removal test but missed on stadium conversion, and paid £323m for it, which is why the scorecard keeps all eight.

<1 year

median time to main post-event use where owner and use were fixed in advance

3 to 21 years

to main use where the anchor or development partner came after the event

CHAPTER 6

06

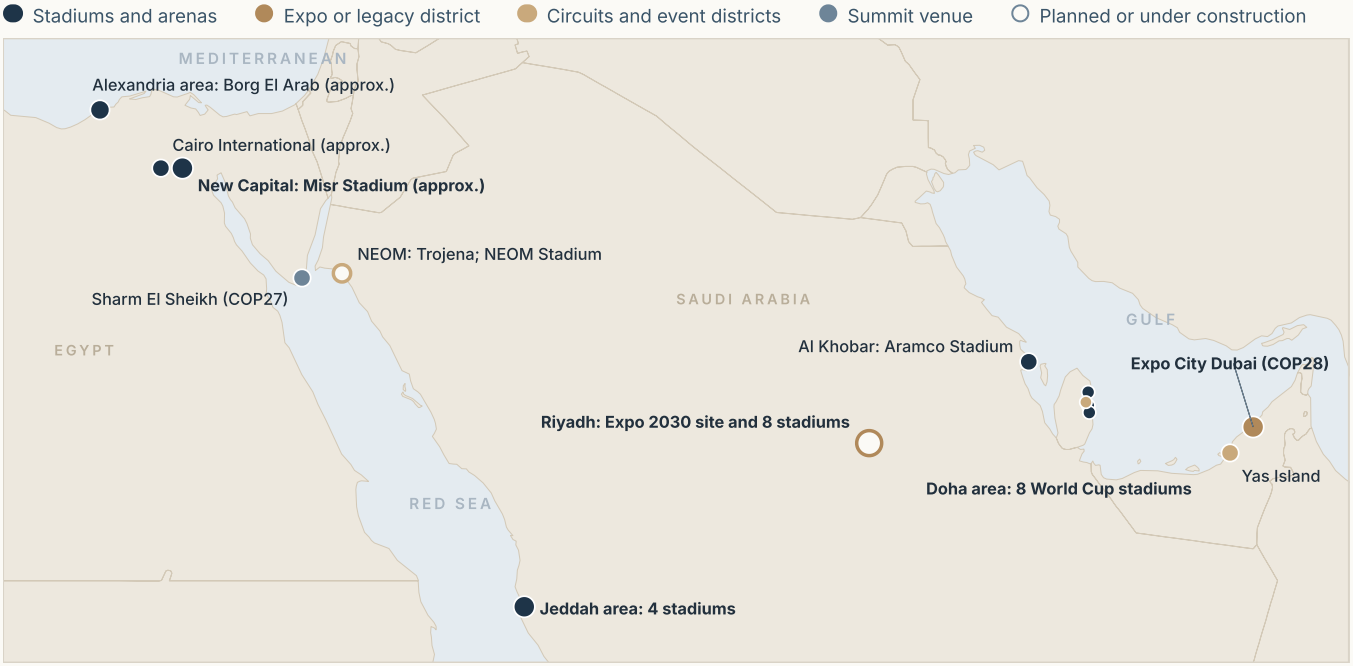
The Gulf and Egypt

Saudi Arabia, Qatar and the UAE hold between them an Expo, a World Cup, two Asian Games and a run of annual events to 2034. Egypt, which hosted the Africa Cup of Nations in 2006 and 2019 and COP27 in 2022, holds about 255,000 seats in its three largest stadiums.

EXHIBIT 16

The region's event sites cluster in five cities and the Egyptian capital region

Selected event venues and legacy sites in Saudi Arabia, Qatar, the UAE and Egypt, 2026



Source: Expo 2030 Riyadh Company; Expo City Dubai; ArchDaily (2024) for the 2034 stadium cities; Al Jazeera (2022) for Qatar's stadiums; StadiumDB for Egypt's stadiums. Positions are GeoNames points for the city, town or island concerned, so all are approximate: Riyadh, Jeddah-area and Doha-area stadiums are grouped; Expo City Dubai is plotted at Jebel Ali, the New Capital about 45 km east of Cairo, Cairo International at Cairo and Borg El Arab at Alexandria. Abha (one renovated 2034 stadium) lies south of the map.

2027	2025-29	2029	2030	2031	2034
AFC Asian Cup in Saudi Arabia; FIBA World Cup in Doha	FIFA U-17 World Cup in Qatar every year	King Salman International Stadium due in Riyadh	Asian Games in Doha; Expo 2030 Riyadh opens	Riyadh Expo site to become the Global Village after the Expo	Asian Games in Riyadh; World Cup in Saudi Arabia

The region has already run one of the benchmark's fastest Expo conversions and its most closely watched stadium legacy plan. The next decade adds 11 new World Cup stadiums and a 6 km^2 Expo site in Saudi Arabia, and Egypt can set the long-term programme for Misr Stadium and the sports city around it now, building on its record as a host at short notice.

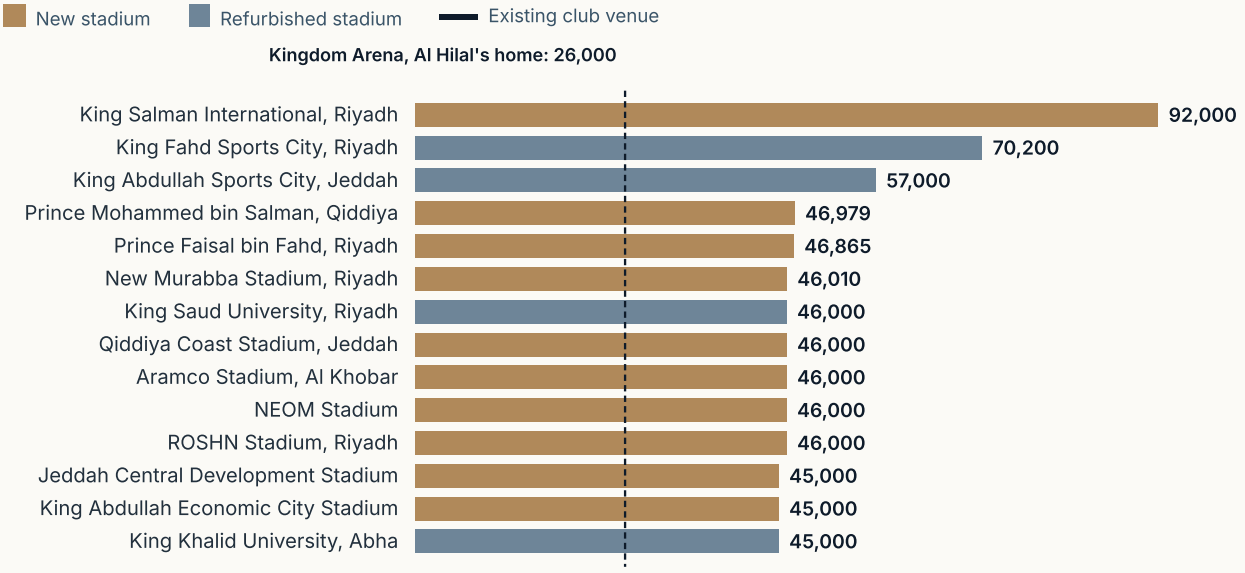
SAUDI ARABIA 2034

Eleven new stadiums for 2034, most listed at about 46,000 seats

EXHIBIT 17

Most of the new bowls are listed at about 46,000 seats, 1.8 times the arena Al Hilal plays in

2034 World Cup stadiums by capacity as listed in 2024 (several given as at least or up to the figure shown), with Kingdom Arena for reference



Source: ArchDaily, Saudi Arabia Secures FIFA 2034 World Cup Bid: Full List of Stadiums Revealed (2024); Saudi Gazette (2024), King Salman International Stadium; The National (2024), Kingdom Arena. South Riyadh Stadium (new) has no published capacity and is not shown; Prince Faisal bin Fahd is counted as new, as in the source; Aramco Stadium is listed at up to 46,000, while its developers give 47,000. Totals are **Heirstone analysis**.

Saudi Arabia was confirmed as host of the 2034 World Cup in 2024, with 15 stadiums in Riyadh, Jeddah, Al Khobar, Abha and NEOM: 11 new and four refurbished. Ten of the new stadiums have a published capacity and total about 506,000 seats. Nine are listed at 45,000 to about 47,000; the tenth, the 92,000-seat King Salman International Stadium in north Riyadh, is due in the fourth quarter of 2029 and is to become the national team's main venue.

The grounds in use today are smaller. Al Hilal plays at the 26,000-seat Kingdom Arena in Riyadh, King Saud University Stadium seats 25,000 and King Khalid University Stadium in Abha 22,000. The plan takes the two university grounds to 46,000 and more than 45,000 for the tournament, and King Saud University's back to 33,000 afterwards.

Several of the new venues are designed for a wider calendar. Prince Mohammed bin Salman Stadium at Qiddiya is planned for sport, concerts and esports, with an Olympic museum. Aramco Stadium in Al Khobar, which its developers describe as a 47,000-seat venue built with ROSHN, has its own Aramco subsidiary and Al-Qadsiah as its home club; it is the only new venue among the eight chosen for the 2027 Asian Cup.

The calendar is full until 2034: the Asian Cup in 2027, Expo 2030 from 2030 and the Asian Games in Riyadh in 2034, the World Cup year. The day-two test for the other new stadiums comes after that, and it depends on the tenants and second uses written into their briefs now.

c.506,000

seats in the ten new 2034 stadiums with a published capacity

33,000

seats King Saud University Stadium is to keep after the World Cup, down from 46,000 for the tournament

26,000

seats at Kingdom Arena, Al Hilal's home in Riyadh

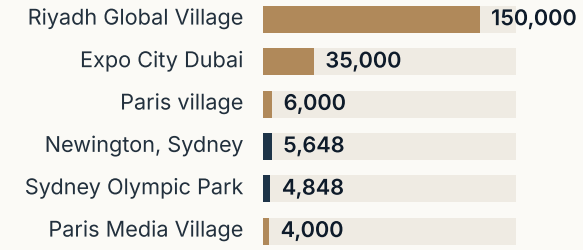
RIYADH AND DUBAI

Riyadh plans a city of 150,000 on its Expo site

EXHIBIT 18

Riyadh plans four times Expo City Dubai's residents, and 31 times Sydney Olympic Park's 2021 count

Residents planned or recorded on former event sites



Source: Expo 2030 Riyadh Company (150,000 residents); Expo City Dubai master plan (35,000); SOLIDEO (Paris village 6,000; Media Village 4,000); ABS, Census QuickStats 2021 (Newington 5,648; Sydney Olympic Park 4,848). **Heirstone analysis.** Gold: planned or targeted.

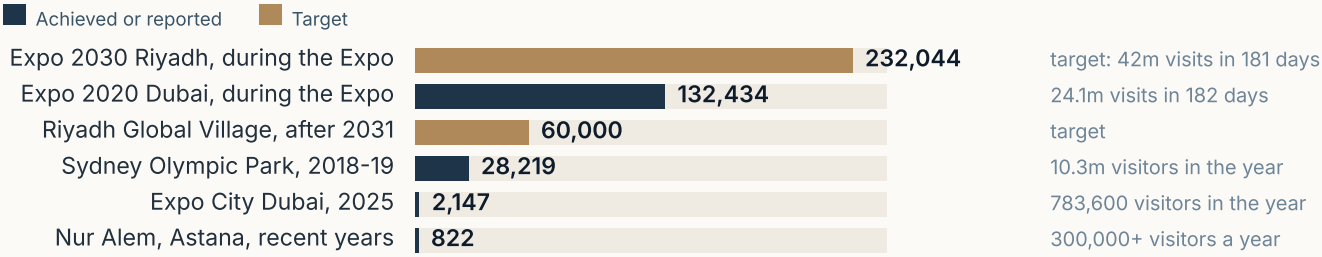
Expo 2030 Riyadh opens in 2030 and runs for 181 days on a 6 km² site in north Riyadh, one metro stop from King Khalid International Airport and beside King Salman Stadium. The organiser expects more than 42 million visits, about 232,000 a day. After the Expo the site is to become a permanent Global Village for 150,000 residents and 60,000 daily visitors.

Both targets are demanding against the benchmark. 150,000 residents on 6 km² is 25,000 people per km², two and a half times the density planned for Expo City Dubai on a site 1.7 times larger. 60,000 daily visitors would be about 26% of the Expo's own daily average and 28 times the daily footfall Expo City Dubai recorded in 2025.

EXHIBIT 19

Riyadh's day-two visitor target is 28 times what Expo City Dubai drew in 2025

Visitors per day: averages during an Expo, and outcomes and targets on event sites after the event



Source: Expo 2030 Riyadh Company (42m visits; 60,000 daily visitors after the Expo); BIE (Expo 2020 Dubai visits); Expo City Dubai Sustainability Report 2025; Sydney Olympic Park Authority, Annual Report 2018-19; BIE, Expo 2017 Astana (Nur Alem). Annual figures divided by 365. **Heirstone analysis.**

Expo City Dubai drew about 2,150 visitors a day in 2025; its value so far comes from offices, homes, a free zone with more than 2,000 licensable activities and events such as COP28. Sydney Olympic Park, with its stadiums and parklands, drew 10.3 million visitors in 2018-19, about 28,000 a day and nearly half of Riyadh's day-two target.

Yas Island shows how a destination builds up around an event venue. Around its Formula One circuit it now has Ferrari World, Warner Bros. World, SeaWorld and Etihad Arena, and in 2025 Disney and Miral announced a Disney theme park resort on the island.

Event calendars also move. The Olympic Council of Asia awarded the 2029 Asian Winter Games to Trojena in 2022, agreed with the Saudi committee in 2026 to postpone them and then signed a host city contract with Almaty. Any venue planned around one marquee event should have a day-two case that can be tested without it.

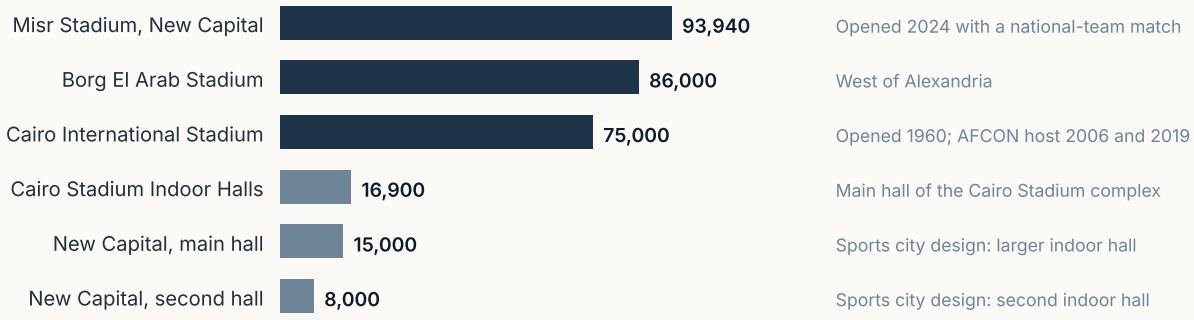
EGYPT

Egypt already has the seats, and a record of staging a tournament at about five months' notice

EXHIBIT 20

Egypt's three largest stadiums seat about 255,000 between them

Capacity of Egypt's main stadiums and arenas, seats



Source: StadiumDB (Egypt Stadium, Borg El Arab Stadium and the New Capital sports city design); Ahram Online (2024), Misr Stadium's first match; Cairo Stadium official website (Cairo International Stadium; Indoor Halls Complex); FilGoal (2019), venues for the 2019 Africa Cup of Nations. The two sports city halls are design capacities from a single source, StadiumDB.

Cairo International Stadium opened in 1960, seats 75,000 and hosted the Africa Cup of Nations in 2006 and again in 2019. Borg El Arab, west of Alexandria, seats 86,000. Misr Stadium in the New Administrative Capital, with 93,940 seats, opened in 2024 with a national-team match against New Zealand.

The stock has proved its worth at short notice. CAF's Executive Committee named Egypt host of the 2019 Africa Cup of Nations at the start of that year, and the first 24-team edition, also the first held in mid-year, was staged in six existing stadiums. A country with large stadiums, hotel stock and a record of staging a 24-team tournament at about five months' notice can offer itself as a host for events that need a venue at short notice, and each such booking adds to the calendar its stadiums need.

The sports city around Misr Stadium, about 45 km east of Cairo, is designed with indoor halls for 15,000 and 8,000 spectators, an Olympic pool and training pitches, according to StadiumDB, and the New Capital Sports Hall was a venue for the 2021 World Men's Handball Championship. That gives Egypt the base to set the district's day-two programme now: an anchor tenant for Misr Stadium, a calendar of continental events and training use by national teams.

Sharm El Sheikh shows the summit route. It hosted COP27 in 2022, and Carbon Brief's count of 49,704 attendees, from UNFCCC data, made it the largest COP up to that time.

c.5 months

between CAF naming Egypt as 2019 host and the start of the tournament, played in existing stadiums

93,940

seats at Misr Stadium in the New Administrative Capital, opened in 2024 with a national-team match

15,000

seats in the larger of two indoor halls designed for the New Capital sports city

THE SCORECARD APPLIED

What the public record shows about day two across the regional pipeline

EXHIBIT 21

Sites past their event score highest; among the 2034 stadiums, the one with a named operator and home club leads

Heirstone day-two readiness scorecard applied to regional event sites on public information, 2026

SITE	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	POINTS FOUND
Expo 2030 Riyadh, Global Village Saudi Arabia	○	○	●	○	◑	◑	○	○	4 of 16
King Salman International Stadium Saudi Arabia	○	◑	○	n/a	○	n/a	○	○	1 of 12
Prince Mohammed bin Salman Stadium Saudi Arabia	○	○	○	n/a	●	n/a	○	○	2 of 12
Aramco Stadium, Al Khobar Saudi Arabia	●	●	○	n/a	○	n/a	◑	○	5 of 12
Eight other new 2034 stadiums Saudi Arabia	◑	○	○	n/a	○	n/a	○	○	1 of 12
Seven new 2022 stadiums Qatar	n/a	●	●	○	◑	n/a	●	○	7 of 12
Expo City Dubai UAE	●	◑	●	n/a	●	●	●	◑	12 of 14
Misr Stadium and sports city Egypt	○	◑	○	n/a	○	n/a	○	○	1 of 12

● commitment published or in operation ◑ stated or partly in place ○ not found in public sources n/a: test does not apply

Tests: 1 owner on day two, 2 anchor signed, 3 day-two size, 4 removal funded, 5 built for the after-use, 6 reopening date, 7 follow-on calendar, 8 absorption and reporting.

Source: Heirstone analysis using the sources cited in chapters 3, 4 and 6: Expo 2030 Riyadh Company; BIE; Expo City Dubai master plan and Sustainability Report 2025; Qatar organiser and press sources as in Exhibit 6; ArchDaily (2024); Saudi Press Agency (2024); Coliseum (2026); Saudi Gazette (2024); Ahram Online (2024). Points found: 2 for a published commitment, 1 for a stated or partial one, out of the maximum for applicable tests.

The scores record what has been disclosed. An empty mark means only that we could not find the commitment in public sources by 2026, and several of these projects are four to eight years from their event. Read that way, the table lists the documents that lenders and prospective tenants are likely to ask for.

Expo City Dubai meets or partly meets every applicable test, as an operating district with a published master plan and an annual sustainability report should. Qatar's stadiums score on tenants, planned size and calendar, and lose points on removal and reporting. Among the 2034 stadiums, Aramco Stadium has a named operating company and home club, and Prince Mohammed bin Salman Stadium has a multi-use design. Expo 2030 Riyadh has published its central day-two numbers; the next documents to look for are the district's owner and partners, its anchor tenants and a reopening date.

The commonest gap is the last test. In the sources we reviewed, no event site in the region publishes residents, occupancy, events and subsidy each year, as Sevilla TechPark and London's legacy corporation do.

12 of 14

points found for Expo City Dubai, the only district in the table already past its event

0 of 8

sites we found publishing residents, occupancy, events and subsidy every year

2024

Misr Stadium opened. It was not built for one dated event, so the event-date tests do not apply; AFCON 2019, staged at about five months' notice, gives Egypt a calendar record to build on

CHAPTER 7

07

What to settle before design freeze

Most of the decisions that shape an event site's second life cost little before design freeze and a great deal after it. These are the actions the benchmark supports, by audience, each with the case behind it.

For the Gulf and Egypt the timing is favourable. Expo 2030 Riyadh and the 2034 stadiums are before design freeze or in early construction, Qatar's larger bowls face a choice between seat removal and a longer calendar after 2030, and Egypt can programme Misr Stadium and the sports city around it now.

HOW HEIRSTONE WORKS ON EVENT SITES

We help landowners, master developers, investors and event hosts plan event sites for the years after the event: highest-and-best-use and legacy studies, demand and absorption analysis, feasibility and business models (DCF, IRR, NPV and Monte Carlo testing), masterplanning and phasing, and benchmarking of the kind in this report.

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GOVERNMENTS AND LAND AGENCIES

1 Write the day-two owner, anchor and permanent seat count into the host agreement, with a published reopening date.
Expo City Dubai was established in the year the Expo closed; Sydney Olympic Park had 65 residents 11 years on.

2 Fund removal at award: no temporary seat or structure without a buyer, a contractor and a date.
London began dismantling its basketball arena within months; Rio's Future Arena became schools only in 2024.

3 Publish day-two outcomes every year: residents, jobs, occupancy, events and subsidy.
Sevilla TechPark and London's legacy corporation already do; we found no regional site that does.

4 Put summits on existing estates and spend on beds and transport.
COP27 in Sharm El Sheikh set an attendance record and COP28 used Expo City Dubai; Belém spent around R$5bn.

BID COMMITTEES AND ORGANISERS

5 Size permanent seats on the average local crowd and add the peak as temporary capacity.
King Saud University Stadium: 46,000 for 2034, 33,000 after; London Aquatics kept 2,500 of 17,500 seats.

6 Test each venue for portability: what it is worth if the anchor event moves.
The 2029 Asian Winter Games moved from Trojena to Almaty in 2026.

7 Use existing and temporary venues where a city has no day-two tenant.
Los Angeles 1984 spent US$0.1m per athlete in Oxford's data, London 2012 US$1.4m.

MASTER DEVELOPERS AND OPERATORS

8 Design the village and media housing as the district's first phase, and deliver some homes before the event.
Paris delivered 950 Media Village homes in 2024, before the Games.

9 Sign an education or research anchor before construction.
Universities or schools took space at six or more of the 30 benchmark sites.

10 Concession venues to an operator with a naming partner, and publish the public grant.
Cape Town's grant came in 31.5% under budget once its naming partner and anchor signed.

INVESTORS AND LENDERS

11 Underwrite on outturn cost, with an allowance for later revision.
Every Games with data overran, by 156% on average; Rio's cost was revised threefold.

12 Price the subsidy line: in our data the public owner carries the running cost where no tenant pays it.
London Stadium was forecast in 2018 to lose more than £10m a year.

13 Phase district finance on an absorption curve of 15 to 30 years, and treat village pre-sales as the first exit.
MIND realised about 35% of its programme in nine years; London pre-sold its village for £825m.

IMPLEMENTATION

A day-two timeline, from bid to the second year after closing

The eight tests are not passed at one moment. Each has a point in the event programme after which passing it gets expensive. The timeline sets each test against that point and against the benchmark case that shows it can be done.

STAGE	WHAT TO SETTLE	TESTS	BENCHMARK CASE
Bid Seven to nine years out	Name the day-two owner and the permanent capacity of each venue. For an Expo, the post-Expo plan must sit in the BIE registration dossier at least five years before opening.	1, 3	Riyadh's dossier, approved by the BIE in 2025, carries its Global Village plan.
Award Host contract signed	Sign the district partner and the anchor tenants. Contract and fund the removal of temporary seats, with dates.	1, 2, 4	London sold its village in 2009 and 2011, before the Games.
Design freeze Before construction	Design permanent buildings for their after-use, with the event as an overlay: floor plates, cores and services for homes or offices.	3, 5	Paris built village sectors to convert and handed them back in 2024.
Opening The event begins	Anchor tenants in residence; the first five years of events booked.	2, 7	Adidas Arena opened with its resident club five months before the Games.
Closing + 6 months First reopening	Hand back village sectors for conversion and reopen part of the site to the public.	6	Expo City Dubai was established in 2022, the year the Expo closed.
Closing + 2 years And every year after	Publish residents, jobs, occupancy, events and subsidy. Re-phase the district on observed absorption.	8	Sevilla TechPark reports firms, jobs and output 33 years on.

EXHIBIT 22

The widest spreads in the benchmark are in residents, density and time to reuse

Range observed across the Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark, by measure, with the case at each end and the regional reference point

MEASURE	LOW	CASE	HIGH	CASE	REGIONAL REFERENCE
Years from closing to main post-event use	0	Hannover (continuous use)	21	Sydney Olympic Park, homes	2 years at most where owner and use were fixed in advance
Permanent seats kept after the event	14%	London Aquatics Centre	88%	Beijing National Stadium	King Saud University Stadium plan: 72%
Village homes per hectare	20	Paris Media Village	313	Harumi Flag	Paris Athletes' Village: 54
Expo visits per hectare	55,030	Dubai 2020	226,038	Zaragoza 2008	Riyadh 2030 target: about 70,000
Residents recorded on event land	65	Sydney Olympic Park, 2011	5,648	Newington, Sydney, 2021	Riyadh Global Village plan: 150,000
Visitors a day after the event	822	Nur Alem, Astana	28,219	Sydney Olympic Park, 2018-19	Riyadh Global Village target: 60,000
Seats planned for removal, Qatar	47%	Al Bayt	100%	Stadium 974	Seven-stadium total: 61%; none confirmed by 2025

Source: Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark 2026 and Exhibits 5, 6, 9, 11, 15, 18 and 19, with the sources given there. Ranges cover achieved outcomes, except the Qatar row, which shows published plans; regional figures in the last column are plans or targets where stated. **Heirstone analysis.**

NOTES, SOURCES AND DEFINITIONS

Notes

Definitions

Day two: the period after an event closes, when its site and venues must find permanent uses. **Main post-event use:** the principal permanent use of a site, such as a district's first residents or tenants, a stadium's anchor tenant or a cleared site's redevelopment. **Years to main use:** calendar years from the event to the opening of that use. **Legacy capacity:** seats after conversion, or planned seats where marked. **Visits per hectare:** BIE visitor total divided by BIE site area. **Density:** residents divided by gross site or district area. **Points found:** the scorecard total from public information, out of the maximum for the tests that apply.

Method

The Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark covers 30 Olympic, Expo and World Cup sites from 1992 to 2025, chosen to include frequently cited successes and failures, the Gulf's recent events and a spread of regions. Figures are as published, in the currency and period stated; we have not converted currencies, and US$ figures for non-US venues are as reported by the source. Where we derive a figure (per athlete, per home, per hectare, shares and growth rates) it is labelled Heirstone analysis and uses only the published inputs shown. Map positions are GeoNames points for the city, district or park concerned and are approximate. Planned figures are shown as plans, not outcomes. Where sources conflict we give the range or the more conservative figure and say so; single-source claims are attributed in the text. Legacy models and scorecard marks are Heirstone judgements on the public record in 2026 and record only what had been published by then.

Use of this report

This report is published for general information. It takes no position on the merits of any host, event or government, and it is not investment, legal or valuation advice. © Heirstone Consulting L.L.C-FZ, 2026. Images are illustrative.

BENCHMARK (CHAPTER 1)

BIE Expo pages; SOLIDEO; LLDC, Our story, Annual Report 2013-14 and Planning Authority Monitoring 2023-24; Queen Elizabeth Olympic Park; ITV News (2013); UCL (2023); Qatari Diar and Get Living (2011); AHMM; Sydney Olympic Park Authority; ABS census 2011 and 2021; Lamda Development; Tokyo Metropolitan Government; Sevilla TechPark; Arexpo; Expo City Dubai; Georgia State University (2017); IOC (2024); StadiumDB; GeoNames (positions).

COST (CHAPTER 2)

Flyvbjerg, Stewart and Budzier, The Oxford Olympics Study 2016; Flyvbjerg, Budzier and Lunn, Regression to the Tail (2020); NAO, London 2012 post-Games review (2012); BIE; Webuild (2025).

SEATS (CHAPTER 3)

NAO (2012); London Assembly (2018); FourFourTwo (2016); Construction Enquirer (2013); Guinness World Records; IOC; Austadiums (2003); SOLIDEO; Al Jazeera (2022), Goal (2018), Arabian Business (2014), ArchDaily, The Stadium Business (2020), Dezeen (2021), Qatar 2022 Supreme Committee, Webuild, The Peninsula, FIFA and FIBA for Qatar; City of Cape Town (2022); StadiumDB; Realnoe Vremya (2018).

HOMES, DISTRICTS AND SUMMITS (CHAPTER 4)

NAO (2012); Qatari Diar (2011); SOLIDEO; Tokyo Metropolitan Government; City of Vancouver; TEHA Group and Arexpo (2025); Human Technopole; Expo City Dubai (2025); UNFCCC; Carbon Brief (2022, 2025); Al Jazeera (2023); Euronews (2024); Turismo em Foco (2020); Rádio Itatiaia (2025).

REGION (CHAPTERS 5 AND 6)

Expo 2030 Riyadh Company; BIE; Expo City Dubai; ArchDaily (2024); Saudi Gazette and Arab News (2024, 2025); Saudi Press Agency (2024); Coliseum (2026); Populous (2024); The National (2024); Gulf Times (2020); Olympic Council of Asia (2022, 2026); The Walt Disney Company (2025); StadiumDB; Ahram Online (2024); Cairo Stadium; FilGoal (2019); Inside the Games (2019); IHF (2021).

Derived figures and their inputs (Heirstone analysis)

Cost per athlete (Ex. 4): Oxford sports-related outturn cost divided by athletes, e.g. Sochi 2014 US$21.89bn / 2,780 = US$7.9m.

Share of seats kept (Ex. 5): legacy seats divided by event seats, e.g. London Aquatics Centre 2,500 / 17,500 = 14%.

Qatar planned cut (Ex. 6): (340,000 design seats less 133,000 planned legacy seats) / 340,000 = 60.9%.

Cape Town grant (Ex. 7): grant used against budget as reported by the city: R41m against R61m, a 31.5% reduction.

London village proceeds per home: (£268m + £557m) / 2,818 homes = about £293,000.

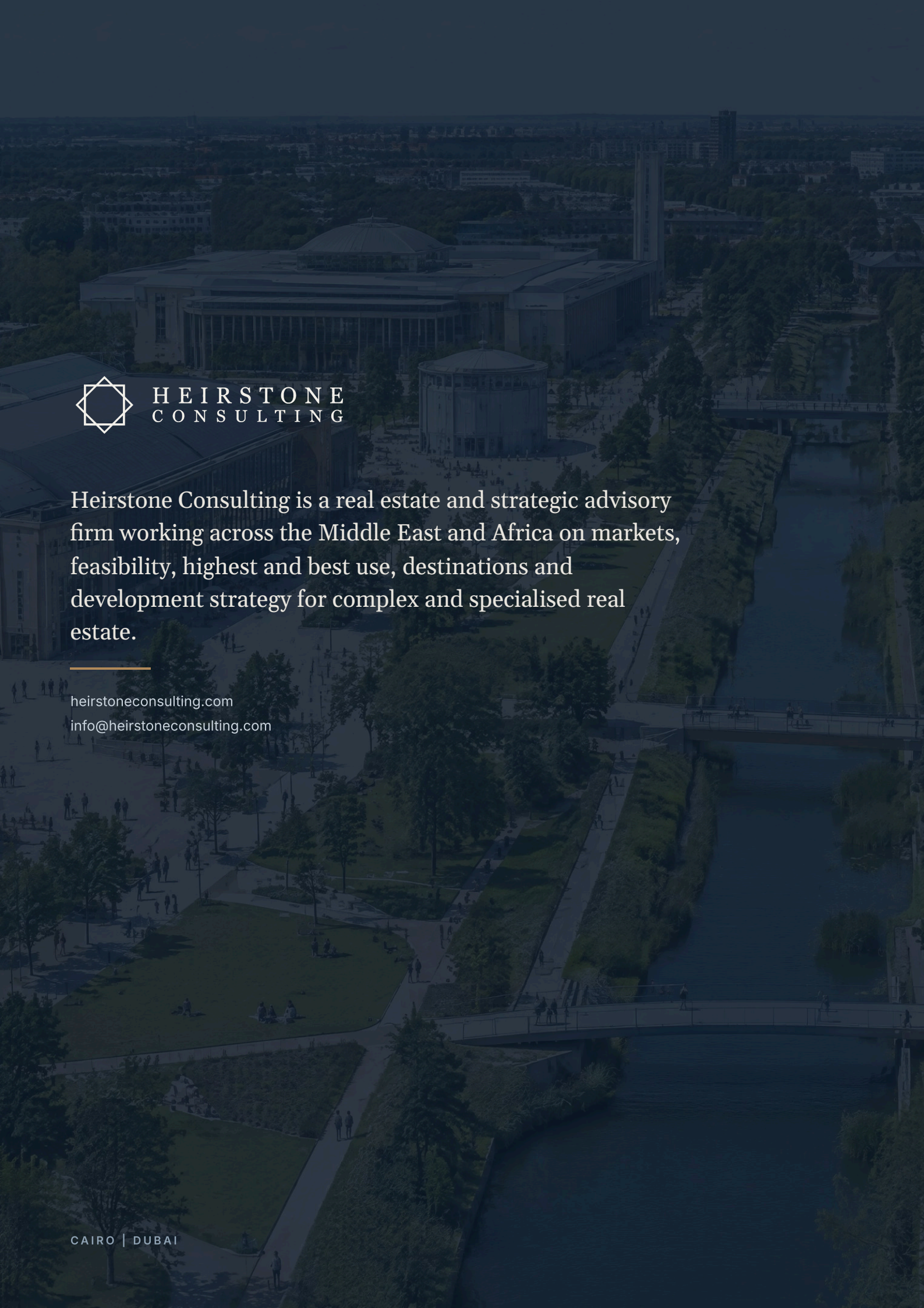
Homes per hectare (Ex. 9): homes after conversion divided by site area, e.g. 5,632 / 18 ha = 313.

Visits per hectare (Ex. 11): BIE visitors divided by BIE site area; Riyadh uses 42m targeted visits on 600 ha.

Residents per km² (text): Riyadh 150,000 / 6 km² = 25,000; Expo City Dubai 35,000 / 3.5 km² = 10,000.

2034 seat totals (Ex. 17): sum of listed capacities for the ten new stadiums with a published figure = 505,854, about 506,000; several are listed as at least or up to.

Egypt seats: Misr Stadium 93,940 + Borg El Arab 86,000 + Cairo International 75,000 = 254,940.



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